Customer Journey Map

Phase 2: Requirement Analysis

1. Journey Overview

The customer journey begins when a traveller opens the Trip Genius AI frontend and ends when the traveller has reviewed, saved, printed or used the generated itinerary to continue planning. The journey is designed around a single main task: convert trip preferences into an organized plan.

2. Stage One — Discover and Understand

The home page introduces the trip-planning task and presents the input fields. The traveller needs to understand what information is required and why. Labels for destination, dates, budget, traveller count, interests and travel style should be visible without forcing the user to learn technical terminology.

3. Stage Two — Enter Preferences

The traveller supplies the starting city, destination, start and end dates, total budget, number of travellers, interests and travel style. The form should prevent avoidable errors, preserve the user’s intent, and provide clear feedback if required data is missing. Invalid dates or unrealistic combinations should be considered in future validation improvements.

4. Stage Three — Generate the Itinerary

After submission, the frontend sends a JSON request to the FastAPI backend. The backend validates the request, calls the Groq model through the AI service, parses the response and checks for required itinerary fields. The interface should indicate that generation is in progress so users do not repeatedly submit the same request.

Potential friction at this stage includes network delays, model quota limits, malformed model output and missing environment configuration. Errors should be surfaced clearly without exposing API keys or internal secrets.

5. Stage Four — Review and Refine

The user reviews the trip summary, day-wise activities, estimated costs and travel tips. Because generative output can contain mistakes, the user should check travel times, opening hours, costs and suitability before relying on it. A future version could support editing and regeneration of selected days.

6. Stage Five — Save and Return

When the user saves a trip, the backend writes trip details and itinerary data to Supabase. The Saved Trips view lists stored trips and provides actions to open or delete a trip. The expected experience is that the user can return to a plan without generating it again.

7. Stage Six — Explore and Export

Hotel and restaurant actions construct Google Maps search URLs. The browser opens search results outside the app, where the traveller must verify listing details. The print/save action invokes the browser print interface and lets the user choose a printer or PDF output.

8. Journey Improvement Priorities

- Give immediate and clear feedback during AI generation.
- Make failure states recoverable and avoid silent errors.
- Label cost estimates and external search links accurately.
- Test Saved Trips after page reload and across sessions.
- Check the layout on smaller screens and with keyboard navigation.

This map is derived from the implemented flow and intended user experience. It is not a measured usability study; user testing should be performed before making claims about satisfaction or task completion rates.